Chapter 1 China's National Defense

The Art of War

opens by stating: "War is a matter of vital importance to the state, the region of life and death, the way of survival and extinction, which must be examined."

Section 1 Overview of National Defense

I. The Meaning of National Defense

National defense, i.e. state defense, refers to the military affairs carried out by the state to guard against and resist foreign aggression, to stop armed subversion, and to safeguard the unity of state sovereignty, territorial integrity and security, as well as political, economic, diplomatic, scientific-technological, cultural, educational and other activities related to the military.

National defense comprises four basic elements:

The subject of national defense is the state.

The object of national defense is foreign aggression and armed subversion.

Resisting foreign invasion is the primary, basic and external function of national defense; stopping armed subversion is its internal function.

The purpose of national defense is to defend national sovereignty, safeguard national unity and territorial integrity, and maintain national security.

The means of national defense

The means and measures adopted to achieve the aims of national defense are divided into military and non-military means:

Military means (armed means): the principal means of national defense, and also its most basic and most effective means.

Non-military means: means in fields related to the military such as politics, economy, science and technology, culture, education and diplomacy; these are the backing and support of military activities.

II. Types of National Defense

1. Expansive type
2. Self-defense type: the type China belongs to
3. Neutral type
4. Alliance type

III. History of China's National Defense

China's national defense can be divided into three periods: ancient, modern (pre-1949) and contemporary.

(I) Ancient national defense

Ancient Chinese national defense began with the Xia dynasty in the 21st century BC and ended with the Opium War of 1840.

1. A systematic military theory took shape

China was the first to create a fairly systematic military theory, with military works such as *The Art of War* (Sunzi), *The Art of War* (Sun Bin), *The Art of War* (Wuzi), *The Sima Method*, *Weiliaozi*, *The Six Secret Teachings*, *The Three Strategies*, and *Li Weigong's Dialogues*.

2. A scientific military system was built

The military system (jun zhi) is the system by which a state or political group organizes, manages, maintains, reserves and develops its military forces, including the armed forces

The military system includes the armed-forces structure, the military leadership system and the military service system, and is a major component of national defense strength. In terms of the armed-forces structure, ancient China generally divided its forces into the central army, regional armies and frontier armies.

3. Remarkable achievements in national defense engineering

City walls were the earliest and most numerous works in ancient Chinese national defense construction. The Great Wall was the continuation and development of city-wall building; begun in the Spring and Autumn and Warring States periods, by the Ming dynasty it had become the Great Wall stretching from Jiayu Pass in the west to Shanhai Pass in the east.

The Great Wall was the most important military defensive work of ancient China.

Ancient coastal defense engineering began in the Ming dynasty. In the Qing dynasty there gradually formed a coastal defense fortress system integrating islands, harbor entrances, coasts and river-defense fortresses.

4. Continuous development of military technology

In the 8th century AD the Tang dynasty invented gunpowder and applied it to military affairs, bringing about an epoch-making change in warfare.

In the Song dynasty the "fire lance" appeared; the fire lance invented by China is the ancestor of all modern tubular spray weapons.

The Yuan dynasty army began to use metal cannonballs.

Ming dynasty artillery fired three kinds of projectiles: solid shot, case shot and explosive shell.

(II) Modern national defense (1840–1949)

1. National defense in the late Qing dynasty
2. National defense in the Republic of China period

(III) Contemporary national defense

1. Stage one: recovery stage (1949–1953)

The recovery stage was the period in which our country resisted imperialist aggression, healed the wounds of civil war and restored the economy.

2. Stage two: all-round development stage (1954–1965)

The all-round development stage was an important period of rapid progress in the modernization of China's national defense.

The National Conference of Senior Party Cadres of the Military System held in December 1953 was a milestone in national defense construction, and set the main tasks: to defend against imperialist aggression, to safeguard socialist construction, and to defend the peace of Asia and the world.

On October 16, 1964, the first atomic bomb was successfully detonated.

3. Stage three: tortuous development stage (1966–1976)

Withstanding the interference and sabotage of the Lin Biao clique and the "Gang of Four" and the pressure of hegemonism, the hydrogen-bomb test and the launch of the man-made satellite were ensured success.

"Two bombs, one satellite" refers to the missile, the nuclear bomb and the man-made satellite.

4. Stage four: modernization stage (1978–present)

In the 1980s, Deng Xiaoping put forward the view that "peace and development are the two major themes of today's world," and a strategic transformation was carried out.

In the 1990s, Jiang Zemin gradually realized the transformation of the army from a scale-and-numbers type to a quality-and-effectiveness type, and from manpower-intensive to science-and-technology-intensive.

In the new stage of the 21st century, the Scientific Outlook on Development (with Hu Jintao as the representative of the Party Central Committee) met the requirements of winning local wars under informationized conditions.

Since the 18th National Congress of the Party, Xi Jinping has set out the goal of strengthening the military under the new circumstances: to obey the Party's command, to be able to fight and win, and to maintain excellent conduct.

IV. Lessons from the History of China's National Defense

1. Economic development is the foundation of a strong national defense

As early as the Spring and Autumn period, the statesman Guan Zhong of the state of Qi put forward the idea of "enriching the state and strengthening the army."

Shang Yang of the Warring States period pointed out: "If the army is not strong, the enemy cannot be crushed; if the state is not rich, the army cannot be maintained."

2. Enlightened politics is the root of consolidated national defense

3. National unity and the solidarity of the people are the key to a strong national defense

4. Advanced science and technology is an important guarantee of a strong national defense

V. The Modern View of National Defense

Modern national defense is the inheritance and development of traditional national defense; on the foundation of comprehensive national power, it is an overall contest in which military means are combined with political, economic, scientific-technological, diplomatic and other means.

The basic features of modern national defense are manifested in the following five aspects:

1. The social character of national defense development

Our army is a people's army; our national defense is the national defense of all the people.

National defense is not merely "military defense"; it is a matter that concerns every field and every citizen.

2. The integrity of national interests and their security maintenance

The function of modern national defense is expanding from maintaining clear geographic "hard borders" to striving for a "soft environment" favorable to oneself;

3. The comprehensive character of national defense strength

The overall strength of a state is the aggregate of the state's political, economic, scientific-technological, military, cultural, diplomatic and natural powers.

4. The plurality of the means employed in national defense

Besides "hard confrontation" with weapons, there are various kinds of "soft damage," such as ideological confrontation, clashes of civilizations and information attacks. One may choose to use one means, coordinated with others, but one must never rigidly stick to a single approach; only in this way can national interests be well defended.

5. The systematic coordination of national defense construction

Modern national defense struggle attaches more importance to qualitative advantage than to numerical advantage, and more to the whole system than to the role of certain individual units.

Section 2 National Defense Laws and Regulations

The main task of national defense laws and regulations is to regulate the various social relations in the fields of national defense and armed-forces development; they are an important part of the state legal system, and the basic basis for strengthening national defense and armed-forces development.

I. The system of national defense laws and regulations

The system of national defense laws and regulations is an organically connected, unified whole composed of a series of national defense laws and regulations. According to the legislative body, the level of legal effect and the domain of the objects regulated, national defense laws and regulations can be divided into different levels and different categories.

II. Citizens' national defense obligations and rights

(I) Citizens' national defense obligations

1. The obligation to perform military service

(1) Serving on active duty.

Active duty is the military service performed by citizens in the armed forces, including service in the Chinese People's Liberation Army and the Chinese People's Armed Police Force.

(2) Serving in the reserve.

The reserve is the military service performed by citizens outside the armed forces; the age for reserve service is 18–35. The reserve is divided into officer reserve and enlisted reserve, and the enlisted reserve is further divided into first-category and second-category reserve. Veterans who pass review serve in the first-category enlisted reserve or the officer reserve. Citizens of conscription age who are not called up for active service in a given year serve in the second-category enlisted reserve.

(Note: both active and reserve service terms are two years.)

(3) Taking part in student military training

2. The obligation to receive national defense education

3. The obligation to protect national defense facilities

The protection of national defense facilities falls into three categories: 1. military restricted zones; 2. military administrative zones; 3. military facilities that are neither restricted nor administrative zones, such as communication lines, railway and highway lines, navigation and aids-to-navigation markers, etc.

4. The obligation to keep national defense secrets

National defense secrets are military or military-related political, economic, diplomatic, scientific-technological and educational matters that concern the security interests of the state and are, under laws and regulations, restricted for a certain period of time to personnel within a certain scope.

National defense secrets mainly take the form of secret information and secret carriers; national defense secret carriers include secret documents and secret articles.

5. The obligation to support national defense development and assist military activities

(II) Citizens' national defense rights

1. The right to make suggestions

2. The right to stop and report violations

3. The right to obtain compensation (limited to direct economic losses)

(III) The relationship between citizens' national defense obligations and rights

National defense obligations and rights are a relationship of unity of opposites: (1) equivalence; (2) equality; (3) unity.

The opposition between obligations and rights is reflected in their different nature and meaning: obligations are passive, rights are active; obligations must be fulfilled, rights may be waived.

The unity of national defense obligations and rights is reflected in: the two arise simultaneously, are closely linked, are conditions for each other, and complement each other.

Section 3 National Defense Development

National defense development includes both spiritual and material development.

I. The national defense system

The national defense system is the general term for the systems governing the organizational forms, institutional setup, leadership-subordination relations and division of administrative authority of state

defense.

The national defense system mainly includes the national defense leadership system, the national defense mobilization system, and the national defense science, technology and industry system.

II. China's national defense strategy

The national defense strategy is the overall conception of safeguarding national security and achieving national defense aims through national defense development and the employment of comprehensive national power. The national defense strategy is determined by the national strategy and state policies, and ultimately gives expression to national interests.

In its national defense strategy, China has always followed the strategic guiding thought of "active defense":

namely, adhering to the principles of defense, self-defense and striking only after being attacked; adhering to the principle "we will not attack unless we are attacked; if we are attacked, we will certainly counterattack";

emphasizing the unity of deterring war and winning war, and the unity of strategic defense and operational/tactical offense.

In 1956, Peng Dehuai's "On the Strategic Guidelines for Defending the Motherland and Questions of National Defense Development" put forward the strategic policy of "active defense."

III. China's national defense policy

The national defense policy is the set of norms by which the state, in a given historical stage, carries out national defense development, military struggle and the use of armed forces, as well as activities related to national defense development. Since its founding, the People's Republic of China has always pursued a defensive national defense policy and opposed all forms of hegemonism and power politics.

The national defense policy has the following seven points:

1. Upholding the leadership of the Communist Party of China
2. Safeguarding national security and unity and protecting the interests of national development
3. Accelerating the modernization of national defense and the armed forces, and achieving the unity of a prosperous country and a strong military
4. Strengthening the quality-based development of the armed forces with informationization as the main hallmark
5. Implementing the military strategic guideline of active defense
6. Adhering to the nuclear strategy of self-defense
7. Fostering a security environment favorable to the peaceful development of the country

IV. Achievements in China's national defense modernization

1. A leadership system for the armed forces with Chinese characteristics has been established and improved
2. Breakthrough progress has been made in the modernization, regularization and revolutionization of the Chinese People's Liberation Army
3. A complete, comprehensive and well-coordinated national defense science, technology and industry system has taken shape

4. The development of the national defense reserve forces has made considerable progress
5. Notable results have been achieved in building the national defense legal system

V. Military-civilian integration development

Strategic measures for military-civilian integration development:

1. Strengthening the awareness of the overall situation; 2. Strengthening reform and innovation; 3. Strengthening strategic planning; 4. Strengthening the guarantee of the rule of law.

Section 4 The Armed Forces

The armed forces generally take the army as their main body and are composed of the army and other regular and irregular armed organizations; the armed forces are the main body of national defense strength.

I. The Chinese People's Liberation Army

The Chinese People's Liberation Army is the principal armed force of the People's Republic of China and the strong pillar of the people's democratic dictatorship.

(I) Development of the Chinese People's Liberation Army

On August 1, 1927, the Nanchang Uprising broke out, firing the first shot of armed resistance against the Kuomintang reactionaries; this was the beginning of the Chinese Communist Party independently leading armed struggle and creating a people's army.

From the autumn of 1927 to the spring of 1928, the Chinese Communist Party launched the Nanchang Uprising, the Autumn Harvest Uprising, the Guangzhou Uprising, the Hunan South Uprising and the Huangma Uprising, among others. The regional forces preserved after these uprisings were at first called the Chinese Workers' and Peasants' Revolutionary Army, and were later successively renamed the Chinese Workers' and Peasants' Red Army.

After the full outbreak of the War of Resistance Against Japan on July 7, 1937, on August 25 the main forces of the Red Army were reorganized into the Eighth Route Army of the National Revolutionary Army,

renamed the Eighteenth Group Army of the National Revolutionary Army on September 11, 1937.

On October 2, 1937, all Red Army guerrilla units were concentrated and reorganized into the New Fourth Army of the National Revolutionary Army, abbreviated the "New Fourth Army."

(II) Overview of the PLA's service branches and arms

1. The Army (Ground Force)
2. The Navy: on December 17, 2019, China's first fully domestically built aircraft carrier, the Shandong, was delivered to the Navy, marking the official arrival of the era of the domestically built aircraft carrier for our Navy.
3. The Air Force: the Chinese People's Liberation Army Air Force was formally founded on November 11, 1949; the Air Force is a strategic service, and its strategic capabilities must keep pace with the constantly expanding national interests and the constantly changing security situation.
4. The Rocket Force: the predecessor of the PLA Rocket Force was the Second Artillery Corps (abbreviated "Second Artillery"), founded on July 1, 1966, the core force through which China

implements strategic deterrence. On December 31, 2015, the Second Artillery was officially renamed the PLA Rocket Force, elevated from an independent strategic branch to an independent service.

5. The Strategic Support Force: founded on December 31, 2015; the Strategic Support Force is an important growth point of our military's new-type combat capabilities.
6. The Joint Logistic Support Force: founded on September 13, 2016.

II. The Chinese People's Armed Police Force

The Chinese People's Armed Police Force, abbreviated the "Armed Police," was founded on April 5, 1983, with its predecessor being the Chinese People's Public Security Central Column.

III. The national defense reserve forces

The national defense reserve forces are the personnel who make the necessary preparations in peacetime and who, through mobilization in wartime, can directly take part in and support a war. The national defense reserve forces include the militia, reserve units, and personnel registered for reserve service in units that have not organized a militia.

1. The militia: a mass armed organization led by the Chinese Communist Party that developed gradually during the long revolutionary wars and does not leave regular production. The militia is divided into the core militia and the ordinary militia. The core militia belongs to the first category of the reserve, and the ordinary militia to the second category.
2. Reserve units: armed organizations organized with active-duty personnel as the backbone and reserve officers and soldiers as the base. Reserve units are distinct from active units and different from militia organizations; they are a form of combining peacetime and wartime, and an important form of rapid wartime mobilization.

Section 5 National Defense Mobilization

National defense mobilization, also called war mobilization, refers to the urgent measures taken by the state, within the corresponding scope, to transfer in a unified manner personnel, materials and finances from a peacetime to a wartime footing in order to prepare for and wage war.

National defense mobilization is closely bound up with war; it is an important component and precondition of war activity.

In December 2020, the 24th session of the Standing Committee of the 13th National People's Congress revised and adopted the National Defense Law, which standardized the basic content of peacetime preparation and wartime implementation of national defense mobilization.

I. The meaning of national defense mobilization

1. The acting subject of national defense mobilization is the state.
2. The object of national defense mobilization is national defense potential resources. National defense potential resources include human, material and financial resources.
3. The essence of national defense mobilization is the allocation and transformation of national defense potential.

II. The significance of national defense mobilization

1. National defense mobilization is an important condition determining the outcome of a war.
2. National defense mobilization is an important basis for determining military strategy.
3. National defense mobilization is an important force supporting economic development.

Good national defense mobilization makes it possible to "maintain a smaller army in peacetime and field more troops in wartime."

III. The content of national defense mobilization

1. Armed-forces mobilization. Armed-forces mobilization is the core of national defense mobilization.
2. National economic mobilization
3. Civil air defense mobilization: (1) establishing and improving civil air defense mobilization plans; (2) providing sound education in basic civil air defense knowledge; (3) strengthening stockpiles of civil air defense materials and equipment; (4) organizing urban air-defense specialized teams; (5) organizing civil air defense mobilization drills.
4. Transportation mobilization
5. Equipment mobilization
6. Information mobilization
7. Political mobilization

Chapter 2 National Security

Section 1 Overview of National Security

I. The scientific meaning of national security

National security means that state political power, sovereignty, unity and territorial integrity, the people's well-being, sustainable economic and social development and other major interests of the state are relatively free from danger and from internal and external threats, as well as the capability to guarantee a continuous state of security.

(1) The subject of national security is the state.

(2) The object of national security can be any real thing, system and its components.

(3) National security includes both external security and internal security.

(4) National security is a basic interest of the state.

II. Basic principles for safeguarding national security

1. Upholding the leadership of the Communist Party of China over national security work (also the fundamental principle of the holistic approach to national security)
2. Upholding the principle of socialist rule of law
3. Upholding the principle of respecting and safeguarding human rights
4. Upholding the principle of overall planning and coordination
5. Upholding the principle of putting prevention first, addressing both symptoms and root causes, and combining specialized work with mass work

III. The holistic approach to national security

(I) The proposal and content of the holistic approach to national security

On April 15, 2014, General Secretary Xi Jinping formally put forward the holistic approach to national security for the first time.

The content of the holistic approach to national security: upholding the primacy of national interests, taking the people's security as the purpose, political security as the foundation, al security, homeland security and the people's security, traditional and non-traditional security, and one's own security and common security, improving the national security institutional system, strengthening national security capacity building, and resolutely safeguarding national sovereignty, security and development interests.

(II) How to adhere to a security path with Chinese characteristics: 1. taking the assurance of political power security and institutional security as the primary task

2. Upholding the primacy of national interests; 3. taking the people's security as the purpose; 4. upholding common security; 5. upholding the promotion of the great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation

Section 2 The National Security Situation

I. Overview of China's geopolitical environment

The region around China has enormous disparities in economic development, which brings great difficulties to regional economic cooperation and security cooperation. China and its surrounding region are the region of the world with the greatest concentration of major powers, with many military powers and a severe nuclear proliferation situation. After the end of the "Cold War," of the world's five major power centers (the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan), all except the European Union have complex stakes and interests entangled with our country. **II. China's geopolitical security situation**

In recent years, with the deepening of China's neighborhood diplomacy of "amity, security and prosperity," the geopolitical security situation in China's neighborhood has been greatly improved. However, the current geopolitical security environment around our country remains complex, with multiple unstable factors, and faces security pressures from many directions.

The United States is a "special neighbor" in China's geopolitical security environment; in every geopolitical security problem our country faces there is the interfering factor of the United States. The American factor may be called the primary external factor.

III. National security in traditional domains

1. Political security: mainly includes the security of state sovereignty, the basic system and ideology, and also the stability of the government system and social order.

Political security is the premise and primary task of national security.

2. Homeland security: the core of national security, the most basic and most important security of a country.
3. Military security: the primary factor among the elements of national security, and the last-resort means of safeguarding national security.

4. Economic security. 5. Cultural security.

IV. National security in emerging domains

1. Science and technology security; 2. Information security; 3. Ecological security; 4. Biosecurity; 5. Security of overseas interests.

Narrowly defined, biosecurity refers to guarding against the negative effects produced by the development and application of modern biotechnology, i.e. the risks that may be posed to biodiversity, the ecological environment and human health.

Broadly defined, biosecurity also includes guarding against major new emerging infectious diseases, animal and plant epidemics, invasive alien organisms, the loss of biological genetic resources and human genetic resources, laboratory biosafety, microbial drug resistance, bioterrorist attacks, biological weapons threats, and so on.

Section 3 The Security Environment in China's Neighborhood

The neighborhood security environment is the totality of external and internal conditions in the region around a state that affect its national security in a given period, including conflicts and disputes with neighboring countries, boundary disputes, military infiltration, subversion and even invasion.

I. Overview of the security environment in China's neighborhood

(I) Basic features of the security environment in China's neighborhood

1. Many neighboring countries: the security environment is strongly influenced by the surrounding countries.
2. Long land borders and vast sea areas: the security environment is strongly influenced by boundary disputes and maritime rights and interests disputes.
3. Located in a zone where the interests of major powers converge: the security environment is strongly influenced by external factors.

(II) Historical evolution of the security environment in China's neighborhood

1. A national defense outlook emphasizing land over sea formed under special circumstances
2. Repeated invasions by the imperialist powers in the modern era

II. The current state of the security environment in China's neighborhood

(I) Peace and development are the mainstream of China's current neighborhood security environment

1. Partnerships of cooperation have been established with the world's major powers

The Taiwan question is always the most important and most sensitive core issue in China–United States relations.

On June 5, 2019, the heads of state of China and Russia decided to elevate the relationship between the two countries to a "China–Russia comprehensive strategic partnership of coordination for a new era." On June 28, 2021, the two heads of state announced the extension of the Treaty of Good-Neighborliness and Friendly Cooperation between China and Russia.

China and Japan both take the development of long-term, stable and friendly relations as their basic national policy.

The European Union is China's largest trading partner, export market and source of technology imports.

2. Friendly relations with neighboring countries are developing smoothly

On the basis of adhering to the "Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence," our country develops friendly relations with all countries.

3. "Hot spots" in the neighborhood are gradually cooling down

There have been many hot spots around our country, such as the Korean War, the Vietnam War, the Afghan war and the India–Pakistan conflict.

At present, the issue affecting our security most is the North Korean nuclear issue, and the second is the serious confrontation between India and Pakistan.

But on the whole, the security environment around our country is tending toward peace and stability.

(II) Insecure factors exist within a relatively stable security environment

1. The Western military powers have a far-reaching influence on our security environment
2. Hot-spot regions in the neighborhood still hold the possibility of sudden changes
3. Boundary and maritime rights and interests disputes remain

Land boundary issues: the China–India boundary dispute; maritime rights and interests disputes: the division of the continental shelf of the Yellow Sea and the East China Sea with North Korea and South Korea; with Japan, the division of the continental shelf of the East China Sea and the ownership of the Diaoyu Islands

4. Foreign forces interfering in the Taiwan question
5. Terrorism and ethnic separatist activities threaten our security

III. We must update the concept of national security, foster a good-neighborly and friendly environment, and strengthen the new strategic security outlook

(I) Building "soft power"

The new strategic security outlook: the comprehensive security outlook.

The content of the comprehensive security outlook: besides political security and military security centered on the concept of sovereignty, international security issues also include a series of new security issues such as economic security, environmental security, cultural security and social security.

Economic security is the foundation of comprehensive security and the fundamental guarantee of lasting security.

China's new strategic security outlook (comprehensive security outlook) mainly includes:

(1) taking the state as the subject of security and highlighting sovereignty security; (2) taking the "Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence" as the political foundation;

(3) taking "mutual security" as the theoretical premise; (4) taking "comprehensive security" as the content of security maintenance;

(5) taking "cooperative security" as the path to realizing security;

(6) taking "common security" and "universal security" as the goals;

(7) taking "mutual trust, mutual benefit, equality and coordination" as the core of the new security outlook.

(II) Committing to developing a new type of major-power relations

1. The principled positioning of no confrontation, no alliance and no targeting of third countries

2. The strategic positioning of a "win-win" approach that embraces overall interests
3. The role positioning of playing multiple roles simultaneously, flexible and adaptable, while never losing sight of the fundamental principle

namely, taking national interests as the fundamental starting point of external behavior. Two countries may be rivals in the political field and partners in the economic field.

(III) Stabilizing the neighborhood and improving the security environment

Our country's good-neighborliness policy takes the Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence as its core.

(IV) Reshaping the national security system and the regional cooperation mechanism Comprehensive national security makes no distinction between peacetime and wartime, nor between front and rear; it requires the establishment of command-control and coordination mechanisms including crisis early warning, response and evaluation, and management support, so as to standardize the national security institutional mechanisms and their various elements.

1. Deepening the institutionalization of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation: the five states of China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan.

2. Actively promoting the institutionalization of the ASEAN Regional Forum

The ASEAN Regional Forum remains to this day a relatively loose form of organization for security dialogue and cooperation, and therefore cannot yet be counted as a regional international security organization in the full sense.

3. Comprehensively advancing the RCEP cooperation mechanism

RCEP stands for the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, initiated by the ten ASEAN countries, inviting China, Japan, South Korea, Australia and New Zealand to take part; it is a free trade agreement aimed at reducing tariff and non-tariff barriers and building a unified market of 15 countries, with member states opening their markets to one another to achieve regional economic integration.

RCEP formally entered into force on January 1, 2022 — a new milestone in the process of regional integration. Trade disputes and conflicts among RCEP member states can be resolved within the RCEP framework, minimizing the impact of disputes and conflicts.

(V) Independently and peacefully promoting a multipolar configuration

Independence and peaceful diplomacy are the primary guideline of China's diplomacy, and also an important guarantee of our opening to the outside world.

Peace and development have become the theme of today's world.

Section 4 The International Strategic Situation

The international strategic situation refers to those long-term, overall developmental trends in international relations, rather than the dynamic changes of individual concrete events. The international strategic situation determines or constrains the objects of a country's political, military and economic struggle, its relations of friend and foe, and the principles, policies and strategies it adopts.

I. The current international strategic situation and future development trends

(I) The current international strategic situation

In the early 1990s, US President Bush put forward the concept of establishing a US-led "new world order."

Russia has maintained its position as the world's second military power.

Japan is the world's third economic power (China is the second).

The core of India's new military strategy is shifting from passive defense to active defense, emphasizing taking the initiative and fighting "limited wars."

(II) Development trends of the international strategic situation

1. Multipolarization will be the inevitable trend in the development of the international strategic configuration
2. The relations among the various parties in the international strategic configuration will become increasingly complicated
3. China's position and role in the multipolar configuration will become ever more prominent

First, it plays a restraining role in opposing hegemonism and power politics; second, it plays an exemplary role in economic development; third, it plays an important role in the struggle to safeguard the rights and interests of the third world.

II. China's proposal for global governance

Building a community with a shared future for mankind.

(I) The scientific content of building a community with a shared future for mankind

The fundamental principle of the thought of building a community with a shared future for mankind is sovereign equality; its fundamental goal and core task is to build an open, inclusive, clean and beautiful world of lasting peace, universal security and common prosperity.

Advancing the building of a community with a shared future for mankind involves both forward-looking, inclusive, creative thinking and strategic design, and important handles and practical measures.

(II) The practice of building a community with a shared future for mankind — the "Belt and Road" initiative

In the autumn of 2013, Xi Jinping proposed jointly building the Silk Road Economic Belt in Kazakhstan and jointly building the 21st Century Maritime Silk Road in Indonesia — the "Belt and Road" initiative.

III. The military forces and strategic trends of the world's major countries

After the end of the Cold War, the overall size of the world's military forces showed a decreasing trend, but the quality level of most countries' armies kept rising; strengthening military forces remains an important means of safeguarding and expanding each country's interests, and a strategic bargaining chip in the contest for an important position in the multipolar configuration.

The strategic trends of the major countries:

1. The United States, with long premeditation, responds to rising powers with a "containment strategy."
2. Russia holds tight to its "trump card," manifesting its great-power status.

3. Japan, taking advantage of the US "return to the Asia-Pacific," builds itself into a "military power."
4. India emphasizes "punitive deterrence" and enhances its military strength.
5. The EU's common defense advances steadily.

In 2017 the EU launched "Permanent Structured Cooperation" in defense — a "historic moment for EU defense" that will provide an important framework mechanism for the EU to formulate a common defense policy and build independent defense forces in the future.

Chapter 3 Military Thought

Section 1 Overview of Military Thought

I. The definition and classification of military thought I. The definition and classification of military thought

Military thought is the rational understanding of the basic questions of war, the army and national defense; it is the summarization of experience and theoretical generalization drawn from people's long engagement in military practice.

The content of military thought can be broadly divided into two levels:

First, military philosophy, whose main content comprises the outlook on war and military methodology; second, the basic guiding principles of military practice, whose main content comprises strategic thinking, operational thinking, thinking on army building, and thinking on national defense development.

II. The position and role of military thought

1. Military thought is the guide of military practice.
2. Military thought is the theoretical foundation for the study of specific military disciplines, and can provide methodology for research in specific military disciplines.
3. Military thought also has important reference value for other social practices.

III. Overview of the development of military thought

(I) Ancient military thought

Ancient military thought includes the military thought of both slave society and feudal society; its emergence and development were concentrated mainly in China and the countries along the Mediterranean.

China was the first to create a fairly systematic military thought; the earliest (Western Zhou) military works include the *Jun Zheng* and the *Jun Zhi*.

The earliest extant and most influential work of military theory is *The Art of War*, written by Sun Wu at the end of the Spring and Autumn period.

Compared with ancient Chinese military thought, foreign ancient military thought started later and lacks systematic exposition.

Ancient Greek military thought: war arises from fundamental conflicts of interest; the aims of war are conquest, the pursuit of the interests of the city-state or state, and hegemony; the outcome of war depends

on political, military, economic and spiritual conditions.

Ancient Roman military thought: it further recognized that war can be just or unjust; the military is a tool for achieving political aims, while politics is in turn a means of coordinating military operations to achieve military ends.

(II) Modern military thought (1640–1917)

From the English bourgeois revolution of 1640 to the Russian October Revolution of 1917 — these 277 years constitute the modern history of the world.

Foreign modern military thought can be divided into two great systems: bourgeois military thought and proletarian military thought.

1. Bourgeois military thought

Clausewitz's

On War

is the outstanding representative of foreign modern (bourgeois) military thought.

Bourgeois military thought:

(1) opposes agnosticism on the question of understanding war, and puts forward the concept of military science;

(2) military science comprises two important components, strategy and tactics;

(3) it advocates exploring the nature and laws of war, and studying the roles of the army, equipment, geography, politics and morale in war.

2. Proletarian military thought

The main representatives of proletarian military thought are Marx, Engels and Lenin.

Proletarian military thought:

(1) holds that war and the military are a historical category, arising and perishing with the emergence and elimination of private ownership and classes;

(2) war is the continuation of politics by other means; one must oppose unjust wars and support just wars;

(3) in the stage of imperialism, imperialism is the root of war;

(4) the proletariat must overthrow the bourgeois regime by violence and establish its own rule;

(5) it should take organizing armed urban worker uprisings as the center, and seize state power by capturing the cities;

(6) whether in seizing or in consolidating power, the proletariat must have its own new-type army;

(7) the proletariat represents the interests of the people, and has the ability and the conditions to arm the people and wage people's war, emphasizing the combination of the army with the masses;

(8) it recognizes that progress in science and technology necessarily brings about transformations in strategy and tactics;

(9) the secret of war lies in the concentration of troops; it advocates active defense, taking the initiative in attack, prudence in decisive battle, and flexible maneuver.

(III) Contemporary military thought

The Italian Douhet put forward the theory of "air war," also known as the theory of victory through air power.

The Englishman Fuller and the German Guderian, among others, put forward the theory of "mechanized warfare," also known as the theory of victory through tanks.

The German Ludendorff put forward the theory of "total war," holding that modern war is total war and advocating the militarization of the national economy.

The French Marshal Pétain, drawing on the experience of the First World War, put forward the theory of "positional warfare," relying on strong fortifications for victory.

The Englishman Liddell Hart put forward the "strategy of indirect approach," advocating avoiding frontal assault and taking a roundabout route.

"The theory of victory through nuclear weapons" and deterrence theory occupy an important place in American military thought.

After the Second World War, in the early 1980s, the American Graham put forward the strategic thought of "High Frontier," holding that outer space is the new strategic commanding height of human activity; in 1983 the United States formulated the "Strategic Defense Initiative," commonly known as the "Star Wars program."

Section 2 Foreign Military Thought

I. The main content of foreign military thought

(I) Modern foreign military thought

The modern period refers to the period in which the capitalist mode of production was dominant, roughly from the mid-17th century to the mid-20th century; militarily it was the era of firearms and mechanized weapons, and nuclear weapons began to appear and be used.

1. In the guidance of war: Emphasis on learning war through war; skirmish tactics came into wide use; one should not set excessive store by the gain or loss of a single city or piece of ground, but attend to seizing opportunities and annihilating the enemy's effective strength; adept at employing surprise attack and winning by unexpected maneuvers.
2. On army building and operations:

Emphasis on building strong reserves, concentrating superior forces at the decisive time and place, and annihilating the enemy's effective strength by resolute offense;

improving the army's organization, making the division and the corps fixed organizational units.

3. In military theoretical research:

In

On War

, Clausewitz put forward the famous thesis that "war is nothing but the continuation of politics by other means," comparatively systematically explored the aims of war, and demonstrated the relationship between annihilating the enemy and preserving oneself.

(II) Contemporary foreign military thought

The contemporary period is from the end of the Second World War to the present; militarily it is the period of transition from mechanized war under nuclear deterrence to informationized warfare.

1. The outlook on war: the causes of war are more complex; the controllability of war has increased; the aims, scale and means of war are all more strictly subject to political control.
2. Strategic thinking: in strategic guidelines, not only is deterrence still emphasized, but in response to various real threats emphasis is placed on carrying out "preemptive" strikes; in strategic means, the role of information in safeguarding national security and in future wars is universally emphasized.
3. Operational thinking: emphasis on the fact that all combat operations in the information age are joint operations or joint actions, and that no single service can independently accomplish joint operational tasks. No longer seeking solely to annihilate large numbers of enemy troops and seize territory, but striking directly at the enemy's political, military and economic centers of gravity.
4. Thinking on army building: mainly emphasizing adherence to principles such as capability-based development, overall national coordination, information primacy and systems integration.

II. The basic characteristics of contemporary foreign military thought

1. Innovativeness: the most salient feature of foreign military thought is innovativeness, especially evident after the "Cold War."
2. Inheritance.
3. Openness: while foreign military thought emphasizes the authority, guiding force and prescriptive character of documents, requiring troops to implement them, it also leaves room for revision, development and improvement.
4. Standardization: although innovation in foreign military thought also encourages "a hundred flowers blooming," once a thought, viewpoint or term is officially accepted it is standardized in the form of official documents or regulations.

III. A representative work of foreign military thought: *On War*

Clausewitz's

On War

is a classic bourgeois military-theoretical work of the 19th century; it systematically summarized the experience and lessons of the French bourgeois revolution and the Napoleonic wars, laying the foundation of modern Western bourgeois military theory.

(I) The military viewpoints of *On War*:

1. The nature of war: war reflects the politics of a state and is one of its instruments; "war is nothing but the continuation of politics by other means."
2. The aim and means of war: war is an act of violence to compel the enemy to submit to one's will.

"Of all the aims that can be pursued in war, the destruction of the enemy's forces is always the highest aim."

"Do not believe the general who claims to win without bloodshed."

3. The role of moral (spiritual) factors in war: the elements that decide victory or defeat in war fall into five categories — moral, physical, mathematical, geographical and statistical — with the moral factor

foremost. The moral factor is composed of three aspects: the talent of the commander, the military virtue of the army, and the national spirit of the army; of these, the commander's talent is more important in war.

4. The role of the armed people: a people's armed force composed mainly of peasants, which regular troops cannot replace, is a powerful means of strategic defense. In a people's war, one should follow the principle of guerrilla warfare supported by the regular army, with small units carrying out limited tactical attacks, waging strategic defense and avoiding decisive engagements.
5. The dialectical relationship between offense and defense: offense and defense are two forms of combat that mutually influence and can transform into each other.

In war, one should follow the principle of guerrilla warfare supported by the regular army, with small units carrying out limited tactical attacks, waging strategic defense and avoiding decisive engagements.

Clausewitz was the first in the history of military thought to put forward the concepts of "active defense" and "passive defense," and advocated practicing active defense while opposing passive defense.

Section 3 Ancient Chinese Military Thought

I. The formation and development of ancient Chinese military thought

(I) Preliminary formation (Xia, Shang and Western Zhou periods)

War was strongly influenced by "superstition," and the management of subordinates and soldiers relied mainly on harsh punishments.

In the Western Zhou period military works such as the *Jun Zhi* and the *Jun Zheng* already appeared; though long lost, they are an important marker of the formation of ancient Chinese military thought.

(II) Maturation (Spring and Autumn and Warring States periods)

The Spring and Autumn and Warring States period laid the comprehensive foundation of ancient Chinese military thought and marked its basic maturity.

The earliest extant and most influential work of military theory is

The Art of War

by Sun Wu of the late Spring and Autumn period — the foundational work of the military theory of the newly rising landlord class, marking the maturity of feudal-class military thought and becoming the model for later military works.

Other influential military works include *The Art of War* (Wuzi), *The Sima Method*, *The Art of War* (Sun Bin), *The Art of War* (Weiliaozi), *The Six Secret Teachings*, and Zhuge Liang's *Longzhong Plan*.

(IV) Systematization (Song to early Qing)

In the Song dynasty, military studies began to be incorporated into the state education system.

II. The basic content of ancient Chinese military thought

(I) The causes, nature and role of war

1. The causes of war — the

Wuzi

: "One is contesting fame; two, contesting profit; three, accumulated hatred; [four,] internal disorder; five, famine."

2. The nature of war — the

Wuzi

: "One is the righteous army; two, the strong army; three, the rigid army; four, the violent army; five, the rebellious army."

3. The role of war

The

Sima Method

: "Therefore, to kill a man in order to bring peace to men — such killing is permissible; to attack a state in order to love its people — such attack is permissible; to use war to stop war — even war is permissible."

The

Weiliaozi

: "Thus the army exists to punish violence and disorder and to forbid unrighteousness."

(II) War and politics

The Art of War

: "One who is skilled in the use of troops cultivates the Way and preserves the laws, and thus can govern victory and defeat."

The *Weiliaozi*: "The army takes the military as the plant and the civil as the root; the military is the surface, the civil the interior." The *Huainanzi*, "Binglüe Xun": "The victory or defeat of an army is rooted in governance. A state whose governance preserves it will survive however small; a state whose governance dooms it will perish however large."

The

Sima Method

: "To govern with righteousness is called rectitude; when rectitude does not attain its end, resort is had to authority, and authority issues in war — it does not issue from mediators."

(III) War and the economy

The Art of War

: "In the rules for the use of troops: a thousand swift chariots, a thousand heavy wagons, a hundred thousand armored soldiers, provisions transported a thousand li; then the expenses within and without, the costs of envoys and guests, materials for glue and lacquer, the upkeep of chariots and armor — a thousand gold pieces a day — only then can the army of a hundred thousand be raised."

III. A representative work of ancient Chinese military thought: *The Art of War* (Sun Wu, late Spring and Autumn period)

The military viewpoints of

The Art of War

:

1. Valuing war, being cautious in war, and preparing for war

- The thought of valuing war.

The Art of War

opens by declaring: "War is a matter of vital importance to the state, the region of life and death, the way of survival and extinction, which must be examined."

- The thought of caution in war. "A state that has perished cannot be restored; the dead cannot be brought back to life. Therefore the enlightened ruler is cautious about it, and the good general is alert to it."

"The rule for the use of troops: do not rely on the enemy's not coming; rely on our own readiness against him. Do not rely on the enemy's not attacking; rely on our having that which he cannot attack."

- The thought of preparation for war. "The rule for the use of troops: do not rely on the enemy's not coming; rely on our own readiness against him; do not rely on the enemy's not attacking; rely on our having that which he cannot attack."

The guiding thought of war: "Know the enemy and know yourself, and in a hundred battles you will never be in peril."

2. "Know the enemy and know yourself, and in a hundred battles you will never be in peril" runs throughout *The Art of War*

3. The thought on the use of troops centered on winning by stratagem

Winning by "temple calculations," winning by "unconventional means" (gui dao), "subduing the enemy without fighting."

4. The thought on army administration of "applying both civil and military means, employing both kindness and severity"

5. Simple materialism and primitive dialectics

Its limitations of era and class: in the outlook on war it failed to distinguish the nature of wars; in army administration there was a policy of keeping the soldiers ignorant; in army supply there was a policy of plunder; and in operational principles there were certain one-sidednesses.

Section 4 Contemporary Chinese Military Thought

I. Mao Zedong's military thought

The main content of Mao Zedong's military thought (comprising five parts):

1. The proletarian outlook on war and military methodology

(1) War is a product of class society and a continuation of politics.

(2) Classified by political nature, there are only two kinds of war: just wars and unjust wars. A just war accords with the fundamental interests of the people and is the motive force of historical development. An unjust war violates the fundamental interests of the people and is an obstacle to historical development.

(3) Communists must support just wars, oppose unjust wars, and eliminate counter-revolutionary war by revolutionary war.

(4) Hegemonism and power politics are the main root of the threat to world peace, and a major reason for the unrest of today's world.

(5) The purpose for which communists study war is to eliminate war and realize the permanent peace of mankind.

2. The thought on building the people's army

(1) The nature of the people's army: the people's army is an armed group carrying out the revolutionary political tasks of the proletariat under the absolute leadership of the Chinese Communist Party.

(2) The purpose of the people's army: the core of the principle of army building is to serve the people wholeheartedly — the essential feature that distinguishes our army from any other army.

(3) The three great principles of the political work of the people's army: unity between officers and men, unity between the army and the people, and disintegration of the enemy's forces.

The three great tasks of the people's army: to serve as a fighting force, a work force and a production force.

The three great democracies of the people's army: political democracy, economic democracy and military democracy.

3. The thought of people's war

Mao Zedong's thought of people's war is the core of Mao Zedong's military thought.

People's war refers to war waged by the broad masses of the people, organized and armed in order to resist class oppression or to repel foreign invasion.

The two basic features of people's war:

1. The justness of the war — the primary condition and political foundation for waging people's war;
2. Broad mass participation — an important hallmark of people's war.

The basic principles of the thought of people's war:

(1) Revolutionary war is the war of the masses;

(2) The deep source of the mighty power of war exists among the people;

(3) Soldiers and people are the foundation of victory;

(4) The factor that determines victory or defeat in war is man, not things.

The main principles for waging people's war:

(1) Adhering to the unified leadership of the Chinese Communist Party over the people's war;

(2) Carrying out broad and deep political mobilization;

(3) Building the broadest united front of revolutionary war and mobilizing the people broadly and deeply;

(4) Establishing consolidated revolutionary base areas;

(5) Taking the people's army as the backbone, combining field armies with regional forces, regular troops with militia and guerrillas, and armed masses with unarmed masses;

(6) Taking armed struggle as the main form, coordinated with struggle on all fronts and in all forms;

(7) Practicing flexible and mobile strategy and tactics.

4. The strategy and tactics of people's war

(1) Despising the enemy strategically, taking him seriously tactically.

(2) Preserving oneself and annihilating the enemy. (3) Practicing active defense and opposing passive defense.

5. The thought on national defense development

(1) Building a modernized, regularized national defense army to resist foreign invasion.

(2) Establishing the strategy of developing cutting-edge national defense science and technology.

(3) The strategic thought of active defense saw new development.

Mao Zedong went on to put forward strategic ideas such as "organizing the people on a large scale into militia divisions," "a nation in arms" (all the people as soldiers), and "dig deep tunnels, store grain everywhere, never seek hegemony."

II. Deng Xiaoping's thinking on army building in the new period

The basic content of Deng Xiaoping's thinking on army building in the new period (comprising five parts):

1. A new understanding of war and peace

1. War has changed from being unavoidable to being avoidable.
2. Peace and development are the two major themes of today's world.
3. Hegemonism is the main root of contemporary wars;
4. Settling international disputes by peaceful means;
5. Developing the peaceful forces that constrain war;
6. Establishing a new international order and realizing lasting peace;
7. Future wars will be local wars under modern conditions.

2. The strategic transformation of the guiding ideology for army building and national defense development

(1) The basic basis for the strategic transformation is the new judgment on the questions of contemporary war and peace;

(2) the relationship between national defense development and economic construction must be handled correctly, with army building subordinated to and serving the overall situation of national economic construction;

(3) the relationship between emergency army and national defense construction and long-term, fundamental construction must be handled correctly, adhering to a path of army and national defense development centered on modernization.

3. Building a strong, modernized, regularized revolutionary army

(1) Unswervingly upholding the nature of the people's army. (2) Army building must take modernization as its center. (3) Army building must raise the level of regularization.

4. Taking the road of elite troops with Chinese characteristics

(1) The army must strengthen quality-based development. (2) Education and training must be elevated to a strategic position. (3) Army building must carry forward the spirit of reform.

5. Adhering to people's war under modern conditions

(1) Under modern conditions, people's war remains the source of China's strength and its advantage: first, the justness of war has not changed; second, the factors for victory in war have not changed; third, the advantages of people's war have not changed.

(2) It is necessary to adapt to new circumstances and combine people's war with the characteristics of modern conditions and modern warfare:

first, increasing comprehensive national power is the objective basis for waging people's war under modern conditions; second, people's war still requires the modernization of the army; third, the structure of the armed forces must meet the requirements of people's war under modern conditions; fourth, the characteristics and laws of people's war under modern conditions must be studied, solving the problems of theoretical guidance and operational command for people's war under modern conditions.

III. Jiang Zemin's thinking on national defense and army building

(I) The main content of Jiang Zemin's thinking on national defense and army building (comprising five parts):

1. Solving the two historic tasks of "being able to win" and "never changing in character"

2. Establishing the military strategic guideline of active defense for the new period

The main content includes: (1) our military strategic guideline has always been active defense; (2) winning local wars under modern technology, especially high technology; (3) preparation for military struggle is the leading element (dragon's head) of the modernization of the armed forces; (4) effectively raising our army's deterrence capability and actual combat capability; (5) developing the strategy and tactics of people's war under high-technology conditions.

3. Comprehensively advancing army building in accordance with the "five-sentence" overall requirements

The five-sentence overall requirements: political qualification, military competence, excellent conduct, strict discipline, and strong support/logistics.

4. Actively advancing the military transformation with Chinese characteristics

(1) Paying attention to and responding to the world's new revolution in military affairs from a strategic height; (2) the focus of structural and organizational reform is solving structural problems; (3) accelerating the adjustment and improvement of policies and systems; (4) innovating and developing military theory with Chinese characteristics; (5) advancing the military transformation actively and steadily.

5. The Party's absolute leadership is the military soul of our army that will never change

(1) Upholding the nature and purpose of the people's army; (2) placing ideological and political development first among all forms of army building; (3) arming the whole army with the Party's innovative theoretical achievements; (4) improving the army's ideological and political work under the new circumstances; (5) carrying forward the fine traditions and conduct of the people's army.

IV. Hu Jintao's thinking on national defense and army building

The main content of Hu Jintao's thinking on national defense and army building (comprising five parts):

1. Fully fulfilling the historic missions of the armed forces in the new century and the new stage

2. Taking the acceleration of the transformation of the mode of generating combat power as the main line of national defense and army development

(1) Unswervingly taking informationization as the direction of the modernization of the armed forces; (2) following the laws of systems development and enhancing the capability for systems operations based on information systems; (3) planning in a coordinated way the development of new-type combat forces, highlighting the building of new-type combat forces as the strategic priority; (4) actively advancing the transformation of military training from mechanized to informationized conditions.

3. Implementing the Scientific Outlook on Development in national defense and army building

(1) Taking the promotion of scientific development in national defense and army building as the theme, and accelerating the transformation of the mode of generating combat power as the main line; (2) strengthening the all-round development of the armed forces according to the principle of the unity of revolutionization, modernization and regularization; (3) taking putting people first as an important concept of army building and administration; (4) raising the overall quality and efficiency of army building.

4. Achieving the unity of a prosperous country and a strong military in the course of building a moderately prosperous society in all respects

(1) Organically integrating national defense development into economic and social development; (2) making full use of the achievements of economic development to advance the modernization of national defense and the armed forces; (3) gradually establishing a military-civilian-integrated economic and social development system.

5. Unremittingly expanding and deepening preparation for military struggle

(1) Focusing on raising the capability to accomplish diverse military tasks, with the capability to win local wars under informationized conditions at the core; (2) coordinating preparations for military struggle in the main strategic direction and other strategic directions, maintaining the balance and stability of the strategic whole; (3) fighting well the political and military battle.

V. Xi Jinping Thought on Strengthening the Military

(I) The scientific meaning of Xi Jinping Thought on Strengthening the Military

Xi Jinping Thought on Strengthening the Military is an important component of Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era, and is the Party's military guiding theory Xi Jinping Thought on Strengthening the Military is the latest achievement of the Party's military guiding theory and the program of action for adhering to the path of strengthening the military with Chinese characteristics and comprehensively advancing the modernization of national defense and the armed forces.

(II) The main content of Xi Jinping Thought on Strengthening the Military

1. It makes clear that a strong country must have a strong military; consolidating national defense and a strong people's army is the strategic support for realizing the great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation.
2. It makes clear that the Party's goal of strengthening the military in the new era is to build a people's army that obeys the Party's command, is able to fight and win, and maintains excellent conduct; striving to basically achieve the modernization of national defense and the armed forces by 2035, and to fully build the people's army into a world-class force by the middle of the 21st century.
3. It makes clear that the Party's absolute leadership over the armed forces is the foundation of building the people's army and the soul of strengthening the military.
4. It makes clear that the armed forces exist to prepare for and fight wars, and must concentrate on being able to fight and to win wars.

5. It makes clear that excellent conduct is a distinctive feature and political advantage of our armed forces.
6. It makes clear that advancing the cause of strengthening the military requires upholding building the army politically, strengthening it through reform, science and technology and personnel, and running it in accordance with the law.
7. It makes clear that reform is the only path to a strong military, and the modernization of the army's organizational forms must be advanced.
8. It makes clear that innovation is the primary force leading development; combat effectiveness must be sought through scientific and technological innovation, building an innovative people's army.
9. It makes clear that a modernized army must build a military legal system with Chinese characteristics.
10. It makes clear that military-civilian integration development is a measure for national rejuvenation and a strategy for strengthening the military.

Chapter 4 Modern Warfare

Section 1 Overview of War

I. The meaning of war

War is the military struggle in which a state or political group, for certain political, economic or other aims, uses its armed forces in large-scale, intense combat; it is the highest form of resolving conflicts among states, political groups, classes, nations and religions.

II. The characteristics of war

1. It differs from social activities such as politics, the economy, science and technology, and culture.
2. It has intrinsic links with social activities such as politics, the economy, science and technology, and culture.

III. The developmental course of war

As to the forms of war, roughly: cold-weapon war, hot-weapon war, mechanized war, high-technology war, and informationized war have been experienced; at present, intelligentized war has also begun to show its first signs.

Section 2 The New Revolution in Military Affairs

A revolution in military affairs refers to the special social phenomenon in which progress in science and technology drives the evolution of weapons and equipment, which in turn gradually brings fundamental changes in army organization, operational methods and military theory, ultimately causing a qualitative change in the entire military form.

I. The main driving causes of the new revolution in military affairs

1. Breakthrough developments in science and technology (most important)
2. The powerful pull of military demand

3. Innovation in military theory

II. The basic content of the new revolution in military affairs

The essence and core of the new revolution in military affairs is informationization, whose aim is to build an informationized army and win informationized wars.

The basic content of the new revolution in military affairs can be summarized as "four new things and one transformation":

1. Innovating military technology and achieving the informationization of weapons and equipment. The generational development of weapons and equipment is an important marker of revolutionary change in the military field. For example, the US military's third "offset strategy," with artificial intelligence as the key supporting technology, achieved innovative breakthroughs in computers, artificial intelligence and 3D printing.
2. Innovating structures and organization, reorganizing the army's structure. The completion of a revolution in military affairs is marked by the final realization of the adjustment of the army's organizational structure.
3. Innovating military theory.
4. Innovating operational methods: since the 1990s, non-contact and non-linear operations have increasingly become important operational methods, delivering medium- and long-range precision strikes directly against targets in the enemy's operational and strategic depth, achieving strategic aims by paralyzing the enemy's entire operational system and destroying its war potential and national will.
5. The transformation of the form of war from mechanized war to intelligentized war:

First, the battlefield is increasingly expanding into a multidimensional space of land, sea, air, space, the electromagnetic spectrum, and psychological and cognitive domains.

Second, the tempo of war is ever faster.

Third, strategic, operational and tactical actions are merging into one.

Fourth, the struggle for information dominance and intelligence dominance has become the focus of contesting the initiative on the battlefield.

Fifth, the degree of integration of army operations is ever higher.

Sixth, the boundary between front and rear is increasingly blurred.

III. The important influence of the new revolution in military affairs

1. It further aggravated the imbalance in the world's strategic balance of power.
2. It further promoted the comprehensive adjustment of the military strategies of the world's states.
3. It further widened the "generational gap" in weapons, equipment and combat capability between the armies of the world's states.
4. It further strengthened the role of military means in safeguarding national security.

Section 3 Mechanized Warfare

Mechanized warfare is the third form of war in human history, after cold-weapon war and hot-weapon war.

Mechanized war began at the start of the 20th century and ran through the entire 20th century; both world wars broke out in the era of mechanized war.

I. The basic meaning of mechanized war

Mechanized war refers to war waged mainly with mechanized weapons and equipment and the corresponding operational methods; it features high speed of maneuver, powerful weapons, a wide battlefield and great consumption, and is the basic form of war in the industrial age.

II. The form and characteristics of mechanized war

1. Scientific and technological revolution is the fundamental driving force.
2. The scale of war expands without limit.
3. Operational organization becomes combined (combined-arms).
4. The influence of the war is far-reaching.

III. The evolution of mechanized war

The mechanized era ran from the 1750s to the 1970s, during which there occurred two technological revolutions and one scientific revolution.

The first technological revolution: from the early 1760s to the late 1840s, marked by the steam engine and the machine revolution, transformed the form of war from hot-weapon war into semi-mechanized war.

The second technological revolution: from the mid-19th century to the early 20th century, marked by the electricity and transport revolutions, transformed the form of war from semi-mechanized war into mechanized war.

The second scientific revolution: from the mid-to-late 19th century to the mid-20th century, marked by the relativity and quantum revolutions; weapons and equipment advanced from the use of chemical and mechanical energy to the use of nuclear energy, bringing mechanized war to a completely new stage.

Section 4 Informationized Warfare

I. Overview of informationized warfare

(I) The basic concept of informationized warfare

Informationized warfare is a new type of war built on the foundation of an informationized society; it refers to war waged with the informationized army as the main combat force, informationized weapons as the main combat tools, and information warfare as the main combat form.

The content of informationized warfare includes the following five aspects:

(1) Informationized warfare is a product of the information age.

(2) The tools of war determine the form of war; the informationization, intelligentization and integration of the tools of war in the information age, and the formation of a system of information weapons and equipment, necessarily give rise to informationized warfare.

(3) The preferred and directly struck targets of informationized warfare are the systems of information acquisition, information control and information use and their foundations, depriving the enemy of information control and use and threatening its information systems.

(4) Informationized warfare will be waged mainly on three fronts — the military front, the political front and the economic front — in both tangible (violent) and intangible (non-violent) ways.

(5) The core resources of informationized warfare are information and knowledge, and the comprehensive contest of matter and energy under information control.

(II) The causes of the emergence of informationized warfare

1. Informationized warfare is the inevitable result of the development of the socio-economic formation.
2. The development of high technology is the direct cause of the emergence of informationized warfare; the backbone military information technologies playing the core role include microelectronics, computers, optoelectronics and military aerospace.
3. The relatively peaceful international environment provided the external conditions for the emergence of informationized warfare.
4. The practice of local wars in recent years is the foundation of the emergence of informationized warfare.

II. The basic characteristics of informationized warfare

1. The dominance of information resources

Geographic targets will steadily depreciate, while information resources will sharply appreciate. Information dominance will inevitably become the commanding height of battlefield confrontation, overriding air superiority, sea superiority and land superiority.

2. The informationization of weapons and equipment

The informationized weapons and equipment system mainly comprises information weapon systems, individual soldier digital equipment and the C4ISR (Command, Control, Communications, Computers, Intelligence, Surveillance, Reconnaissance) system.

Among these, information weapon systems are divided into soft-kill and hard-kill types; individual soldier digital equipment, also called the information soldier system, consists of five subsystems: the individual computer and radio subsystem, the integrated helmet subsystem, the weapon subsystem, the integrated body-protection subsystem and the power-supply subsystem.

3. The multidimensionality of the operational space

Information space includes electromagnetic space, cyberspace and psychological space, covering the battlefield domains of land, sea, air and space.

Among these, the electromagnetic battlefield is called the "fifth-dimensional battlefield," after land, sea, air and space.

4. The acceleration of the tempo of operations.

Three main factors shorten the duration of war: (1) the speed of information flow on the battlefield has increased; (2) the suddenness of war has grown and its time-sensitivity has markedly risen; (3) precision operations are widely conducted, with sharply increased destructive effectiveness.

5. The integration of operational elements

1. Integration of combat forces. 2. Integration of combat actions.
2. Integration of operational command: the C4ISR system provides accurate battlefield intelligence, rapid communications, scientific decision support and real-time feedback monitoring for operational command, flattening the tree-shaped command structure into a networked one.
3. Integration of comprehensive support. 5. Flattening of operational command. 6. Precision of operational actions.

III. National defense development under informationized warfare

1. National defense development must keep pace with the development of the informationization of the armed forces. The winning concept of mechanized war is the large-scale annihilation of the enemy's effective strength; the winning concept of informationized war is to control the enemy into paralysis, achieving the aim of subduing the enemy by skillful fighting.
2. Vigorously strengthen the construction of the national information infrastructure. 3. Strive to cultivate a contingent of national-defense informationization talent. 4. Accelerate the process of informationization of national defense and the armed forces.

IV. The development trends of informationized warfare

1. The forms of expression of war keep expanding: (1) the external destructiveness of war weakens; (2) the layers of war become more blurred; (3) the subjects of war become diversified.
2. The power of war is enormously enhanced.

Future informationized war will be built on the military engineering revolution (which began earliest), the military detection revolution, the military communications revolution and the military intelligence revolution. New-concept weapons capable of causing large-scale destruction include infrasonic weapons, electromagnetic pulse weapons, laser weapons and weather weapons, giving informationized war the power of a sub-nuclear war.

I. The meaning and classification of informationized equipment

(I) The meaning of informationized equipment

Informationized equipment refers to equipment employing modern information technology and having single or multiple information functions; it is the important material and technological foundation of informationized war, and the main body of the tools and means of informationized war.

Informationized equipment has five features:

1. Using networked technology to achieve the coordinated operation of weapons and equipment as a whole
2. Using integrated technology to achieve the functional integration of weapons and equipment
3. Precision is the main goal pursued by informationized weapons and equipment
4. Stealth is an important direction in the development of informationized weapons and equipment
5. Intelligentization is the main trend in the development of informationized weapons and equipment

(II) The classification of informationized equipment

Informationized weapons and equipment are divided into three great systems: informationized combat platforms, integrated electronic information systems, and informationized lethal weapons.

II. The influence of informationized equipment on modern operations

1. Raising comprehensive combat capability and the level of automation
2. Raising the army's round-the-clock, all-weather combat capability
3. Raising the degree of intelligentization of control and command

III. The development trends of informationized equipment

1. The scope of application keeps expanding.
2. The scale gradually shrinks.
3. The varieties and models of weapons and equipment are being simplified and reduced.
4. The technological content keeps rising.
5. The required financial investment keeps growing.
6. The system of informationized weapons and equipment will become the material foundation and main body for conducting integrated joint operations.

Section 2 Informationized Combat Platforms

1. Supersonic aircraft. 2. Tanks and armored vehicles. 3. Aircraft carriers.

By displacement, carriers are divided into large carriers (over 60,000 tons), medium carriers (30,000–60,000 tons) and small carriers (under 30,000 tons); by combat mission, into attack carriers and anti-submarine carriers.

The official delivery and commissioning of the Liaoning on September 25, 2012 marked China's entry into the aircraft-carrier era.

Section 3 Integrated Electronic Information Systems

The integrated electronic information system (command information system) is a military information system centered on computer networks, capable of real-time acquisition, transmission and processing of operational information, used to support command organs at all levels in the scientific and efficient command and control of subordinate units and weapons and equipment.

The integrated electronic information system mainly comprises the command and control system, the intelligence and reconnaissance system, the early-warning and detection system, the communications system and the comprehensive support system.

Section 4 Informationized Lethal Weapons

I. Precision-guided weapons: 1. command guidance technology; 2. inertial guidance technology

II. Nuclear, biological and chemical weapons

III. Robots

IV. New-concept weapons: a class of new weapons that, compared with traditional weapons, differ fundamentally in basic principles, kill and destruction mechanisms and operational methods, and are still under development or exploration.

1. The types of new-concept weapons: (1) directed-energy weapons; (2) kinetic-energy weapons; (3) non-lethal weapons and certain other new soft-kill weapons.

2. Various new-concept weapons: (1) laser weapons; (2) particle-beam weapons; (3) electromagnetic railguns; (4) high-power microwave weapons.

3. The development trends of new-concept weapons:

1. Laser weapons and kinetic-energy weapons will receive priority development.
2. Supporting research on operational theory will receive greater attention.
3. Derived technologies will find better application and dissemination.

Outstanding problems: (1) new-concept weapons face many technological thresholds; (2) the R&D costs of new-concept weapons are high; (3) the pace of equipment-fielding of new-concept weapons is slow.